D174 | A stage is not released money

PRIVATE SYNTHETIC sponsor memo and tracker. Lakh INR over three months. Original case/rubric retained. No actual outreach, test participant, budget, launch or sponsor commitment.

Mutually exclusive paths	Opening unrestricted cash 12; existing burn 1/month for 3 months; no receipts/other flows. Defer ends 9. Discovery-only costs 2 total in month 1 and ends 7. Staged growth costs 1/2/3, total 6, and ends 3. Do not add alternative budgets together.
Cash gate, not permission	Staged month-end cash 10/7/3 breaches floor 4 in month 3. At fixed assumptions month 3 stage spend must be at most 2 to keep floor 4. Affordable does not mean authorized. Dated intramonth minimum and committed obligations still need evidence.
Keep states separate	Tracker records planned spend and dependencies. Actual released/spent/committed cells remain blank because no real execution happened. Stopping uncommitted work does not cancel contracts or erase existing obligations.
Evidence before stage 2	Require defined eligible-user denominator, pre-specified success/stop criteria and a permission-cleared test plan. No real user recruitment, private data upload or recording is required or authorized. Product prototype is not evidence of actual paid demand.
Evidence before stage 3	Require supported outcomes, complete headroom including commitments, risk review and separate budget authorization. Unknown benefits mean no option automatically wins solely by cash. S/F/P/G/R are fictional role labels, not people who accepted responsibility.
Deliverable and scope	Memo is one editable printed page; Tracker plus cash/inputs/evidence support it. Actual decision/objection log stays blank. Relative day 0-30/31-60/61-90 is a proposed plan, not measured delivery or appointments. Native QA cannot validate real outcomes or overall 10/10.

Inputs | One horizon, no double spending

All figures Case-v 1 assumptions, lakh INR. Existing burn excludes the additional alternatives. Yellow values editable; a structural pass does not establish feasibility or authority.

Opening unrestricted cash	12.00
Existing monthly burn	1.00
Minimum endpoint cash floor	4.00
Discovery-only expense, month 1	2.00
Staged expense, month 1	1.00
Staged expense, month 2	2.00
Staged expense, month 3	3.00

Inputs valid? (1=yes)	1.00

Negative computed cash is a visible funding failure, not an invalid input. This simplified model has no receipts, financing, liabilities or cash timing within months; do not infer those are absent in a real business.

Cash | Compare exclusive paths

Lakh INR. Month-end endpoints only. Actual spending and minimum intramonth cash are unobserved. Original staged spend is not silently cut to meet the floor.

Measure	Defer	Discovery-only	Staged growth
Month 1 extra expense	0.00	2.00	1.00
Month 2 extra expense	0.00	0.00	2.00
Month 3 extra expense	0.00	0.00	3.00
Total extra expense	0.00	2.00	6.00
Month 1 ending cash	11.00	9.00	10.00
Month 2 ending cash	10.00	8.00	7.00
Month 3 ending cash	9.00	7.00	3.00
Lowest modeled month-end cash	9.00	7.00	3.00
Month-end floor met? (1=yes)	1.00	1.00	0.00
Month 3 margin over floor	5.00	3.00	-1.00
Month 3 maximum stage spend			2.00

Baseline ceiling 2 is conditional, not budget approval. If ceiling is negative, even zero stage spend cannot clear the month 3 floor without other changes. Reduce only uncommitted work under real authority; include existing commitments in a complete plan.

Tracker | Planned is not approved

Fictional owners. Blank actual release/spend/commitment cells intentionally record no execution. All numbers lakh INR. Stop freezes uncommitted future work, not existing contracts.

Window / owner	Planned expense	Budget released ACTUAL	Spent ACTUAL	Committed ACTUAL	Proposed due	Evidence / dependency	Stop / decision record
Day 0-30 / S F R	1.00				Day 30	S scope; F cash; R actual allowed use and audience. Discovery 1, not a participant grant.	Stop real use/access without authority. No accepted real owner.
Day 31-60 / P G	2.00				Day 60	Defined eligible-user denominator, pre-set criteria and permission-cleared test plan before stage 2.	Failure freezes uncommitted stage 2, not contracts. No actual test.
Day 61-90 / S F R	3.00				Day 90	Documented outcome evidence, cash plus commitments, risk review and separate budget decision.	Original stage 3=3 fails endpoint floor. Redesign/defer; ceiling 2 not release.

S sponsor scope; F finance cash; P product evidence; G test design; R permission/risk. Named fictional roles do not imply actual acceptance. Planning allowances are neither released budgets nor actual expenditures. Do not enter zeros as if actual accounting records were observed.

Memo | Revise stage 3 or defer

One-page authored private sponsor memo. Conditional proposal only. Original case, lakh INR, three-month horizon. Not an actual sponsor email, approved budget or pilot launch.

Decision	Do not execute the original staged plan on cash assumptions alone. Original cash ends 3 below floor 4. Under fixed burn/earlier stages, month 3 spend ceiling is 2, not the original 3. Actual authority, commitments, evidence and timing remain open.
Compare alternatives	Defer ends 9; discovery-only spends 2 in month 1 and ends 7; staged 1/2/3 ends 10/7/3. These exclusive alternatives differ in unknown evidence/benefits and reversibility. More cash does not establish best business outcome.
Dependency and authority	Before stage 2 require denominator, success/stop criteria and permission-cleared design. Before stage 3 require outcomes, complete cash/commitments, risk review and separate budget authorization. Numeric headroom never supplies those approvals.
Fictional accountability	S decides scope, F reconciles cash, P owns synthetic prototype evidence, G test design, R permission checks. Relative 0-30/31-60/61-90 proposed windows are not actual due dates or real responsibility acceptance.
Strongest authored objection	Stopping spend may lose learning opportunity. Response: model alternative scope with its own benefit/commitment/timing evidence rather than claim all 6 is affordable. Existing contracts remain obligations even when future work stops. Actual reviewer objection/change remains blank.
Next evidence and stop	Reconcile released/spent/committed budgets and next-stage decision record. Freeze affected real activity without actual source/participant/budget authority. No test, outreach, recording, launch or delivery performance was observed by this practice.

Evidence | Stated case, unknown execution

All numeric inputs invented in original D174 at https://top1os.dev/. Build 13 November 2026 is not a company observation/source date. No new empirical source reading claimed.

E01 | Case-v1 inputs	Inputs B6:B12 -> Cash B6:D22 -> Tracker planned B6:B8 -> Memo. Opening 12/burn 1/floor 4/discovery 2/staged 1,2,3. These are synthetic assumptions, not audited books, accepted spend or actual resource commitments.
E02 | Scope change	Original staged budget 6 is explicit. Conditional stage 3 ceiling 2 follows 7 cash after month 2 minus burn 1 minus floor 4. Cutting 1 is a new proposed scope, not evidence benefits stay unchanged or a vendor contract can be canceled.
E03 | Outcome unknowns	Eligible users, delivered tests, success denominator, product adoption, cash timing, liabilities, rights and real approvals absent. Do not populate tracker actuals with invented zeros or claim planned targets as achieved.
E04 | Independent transfer	Closed notes: raise existing burn to 2/month and derive staged cash 9/5/0 and month 3 ceiling -1. Explain why zero stage 3 spend is still insufficient. Restore baseline before separately testing stage 3 spend 2 -> final 4, equality not breach.
E05 | Source evidence later	For any real source record publisher/document/retrieval dates/page/definition/unit/window/actual-vs-assumed/reviewer/downstream cells and allowed audience. A prototype or signed-looking role box cannot supply private participant or budget permission.

Audit | Cash identities before decisions

Numeric input checks are not approvals. This separate gate tests formulas and blocks summary outputs on a broken cash reference. Baseline static Memo is Case-v 1 prose and must be revised after edits.

Cash identities and formulas valid? (1=yes)	1.00
Staged endpoint floor flag (1=met)	0.00
Stage 3 maximum under fixed assumptions	2.00
Staged cash after month 3	3.00

The audit flag is not real accounting or independent review. Static prose and source figures remain Case-v 1; edit those before exporting a changed scenario. A negative stage ceiling means zero extra spend is still insufficient. Floor equality is not surplus.

Actual work | No completed learner or sponsor record

Use only real observed work if performed. These blank rows do not certify testing, execution, budget, participant permission or mastery.

Actual date / version	Original memo / calculation	Observed weakness / evidence	Budget state / source	Correction / affected scope	Actual objection / changed view	New transfer / actual result

Actual work remains blank. Record only what occurred: dates, reasoning, error/source/correction, strongest objection and a new delayed transfer. No invented learner results, sponsor acceptance, actual budget release or signed rights.

Failure log | Authored execution only

Observed native tests are added only after execution. Not actual learner mistakes, independent human audit, Excel/Sheets parity, real authority or overall 10/10.

Controlled test	Observed authored outcome
Baseline alternatives / ceiling	PASS: three independent exclusive cash paths and conditional ceiling.
Burn 2 transfer / restore	PASS: burn 2 sensitivity makes staged 9/5/0 and ceiling -1; restored.
Stage 3 spend 2 equality / restore	PASS: stage 3 spend 2 yields final 4, equality not breach; restored.
Invalid negative/text/blank	PASS: blank/text/negative inputs block affected decision summaries.
Broken cash formula / restore	PASS: broken staged cash reference blocked Audit, restored.
Actual budget/attempts blank	PASS: actual releases/spent/commitments/learner work remain blank.

Only the original synthetic course exercise at https://top1os.dev/ supplies the case figures. No new empirical reading, real participants, company records, Indian legal clearance, actual commitments or source completeness claimed.